

Preliminary Incident Assessment: Coordinated Service Disruption

Cyber Situational Awareness Unit

Report reference CSA-2026-0418, issued 18 September 2026

Distribution: official use. This assessment is preliminary.

1. Summary

Between 02:14 and 09:47 IST on 12 September 2026, a coordinated distributed denial-of-service campaign caused sustained degradation of service availability across 37 systems operated by 4 public-sector entities.

Preliminary analysis indicates that approximately 68% of the affected systems were restored within the first six hours of detection. The campaign is assessed as mitigated as of 14 September 2026.

2. Background

The affected entities operate citizen-facing service portals hosted across two regional data centres. Baseline aggregate load across the monitored estate averages 14,200 requests per second during business hours. Automated volumetric alerting was in place at 3 of the 4 entities at the time of the incident.

An unrelated maintenance window was in progress at one entity between 01:00 and 03:00 IST on 12 September 2026. Some telemetry from that window may be incomplete, and the assessment below treats it accordingly.

3. Observed impact

Metric	Baseline	Incident peak	Change
Aggregate requests per second	14,200	186,400	+1,212%
Peak volumetric load (Gbps)	2.1	486	+483.9
Distinct source addresses	n/a	12,400	n/a
Systems degraded	0	37	+37
Mean time to restore (hours)	n/a	6.2	n/a

4. Attack characteristics

Traffic was predominantly UDP reflection with a smaller volume of application-layer requests against authentication endpoints. Peak volumetric load measured 486 Gbps. Traffic originated from approximately 12,400 distinct source addresses across 31 countries. Attribution to any specific actor remains unconfirmed.

Indicators of compromise have been circulated separately. No evidence of data exfiltration has been identified to date; this does not by itself establish that none occurred, as log retrieval at two entities is still in progress.

5. Estimated cost

The estimated financial impact is Rs 12.4 crore, comprising service unavailability, incident response effort and emergency mitigation capacity. This figure is an initial projection and has not been independently audited.

6. Limitations

This assessment is preliminary and is based on telemetry available as of 17 September 2026. Some affected entities had not completed log retrieval at the time of writing, so the figures above may be revised.

The restoration figure of approximately 68% is derived from entity self-reporting and has not been independently verified against system telemetry.

Attribution remains unconfirmed. Source addresses observed in reflection traffic do not identify an originating actor, and no claim of responsibility has been assessed as credible.

The count of 37 affected systems covers the monitored estate only. Systems outside central monitoring may have been affected without being recorded here.

7. Recommended actions

Extend automated volumetric alerting to the remaining entity. Complete log retrieval at the two outstanding entities before this assessment is finalised.

Review upstream scrubbing capacity against the observed 486 Gbps peak.